

Cost reference

What this app actually spends money on, and where. Two sources: Azure OpenAI (drafting sequences) and Smartlead (sending them). Ocean.io (lookalikes + contacts) isn't covered here since it isn't scoped for this doc — ask if you want it added too. Prices as published by each vendor as of **September 2026**; re-check before budgeting, since SaaS/API pricing changes without notice.

1. Sequence generation (Azure OpenAI)

`/api/sequence` calls Azure OpenAI once per click of **"Generate sequence"** or **"Regenerate sequence"** on the Sequence step. ("Rewrite this step" in the UI has no handler wired up yet — it doesn't currently call the API or cost anything.)

Model: `gpt-4o-mini` (from this app's `AZURE_OPENAI_MODEL` env var). Azure OpenAI pricing for gpt-4o-mini, standard pay-as-you-go deployment:

	Price
Input tokens	\$0.15 per 1M tokens
Output tokens	\$0.60 per 1M tokens

What one call costs: based on what this route actually sends —

Component	Est. tokens	Why
System prompt	~300	Fixed instructions in <code>SYSTEM_PROMPT</code>
Structured-output schema	~400–600	The Zod <code>SequenceSchema</code> sent as a JSON schema (field names + descriptions) so the model returns valid structured JSON
User prompt	~400–500	Case study answers + targeting text — scales with how much text is filled into the case study fields
Input total	~1,200–1,400	
Output (4 steps, the default)	~1,000–1,100	Each step: subject, hook, ≤120-word content, CTA, sources
Output (6 steps, the max)	~1,500–1,700	

At those volumes: **~\$0.0008–0.001 per generation** (4 steps) and **~\$0.001–0.0012** at the 6-step max — a fraction of a cent either way. Hitting "Regenerate" ten times in a row while iterating on copy costs roughly a cent total. This is an estimate from the prompt's actual structure, not a metered figure — check the Azure OpenAI resource's usage/cost blade in the Azure portal for real numbers, since exact tokenization depends on the live case-study text.

Practical takeaway: sequence drafting cost is negligible next to Smartlead's per-contact/per-send costs below — not worth optimizing unless generation volume grows by orders of magnitude (e.g. an automated bulk-regeneration workflow).

2. Sending (Smartlead)

Scope: *what Smartlead does (and doesn't) do here*

Smartlead is wired into the **sending step** (</api/smartlead/launch>, fired from the review page's "Approve & push to Smartlead" button). It creates a Smartlead campaign from the approved sequence + revealed contacts, and — if a mailbox is already connected in your Smartlead account — assigns it, sets a schedule, and starts sending automatically.

Ocean.io still does company lookalike search (</api/lookalikes>) and people search + email/phone reveal (</api/contacts>) — Smartlead's API has no equivalent to either (confirmed against its live docs, Sept 2026; its "SmartProspect" lead database is dashboard-only, not exposed via API). See *SmartProspect* below.

The three things that cost money

Term	What it means	What consumes it
Contact / active lead	A unique email address stored in your Smartlead account, counted against your plan's contact cap	Every person /api/smartlead/launch adds via POST /campaigns/{id}/leads
Email send	One individual email delivered, across any campaign	Every step × every contact that actually gets sent
Verification credit	1 credit = 1 email verified for deliverability	Only spent if you verify contacts inside Smartlead; this app's contacts already come pre-verified from Ocean.io's reveal, so this shouldn't be needed in the normal flow

Creating a campaign (</campaigns/create>), saving a sequence (</campaigns/{id}/sequences>), assigning senders, and setting a schedule are all free API calls — no credits either way.

Plan tiers

Plan	Monthly	Annual (~17% off)	Contacts	Emails / month	Free verified emails included
Base	\$39	~\$32.50/mo (\$390/yr)	2,000	6,000	2,000
Pro	\$94	~\$78.30/mo (\$939.60/yr)	30,000	90,000	30,000
Unlimited Smart	\$174	~\$144.50/mo (\$1,734/yr)	Unlimited	150,000	50,000
Unlimited Prime	\$379	~\$314.60/mo (\$3,775.20/yr)	Unlimited	500,000	170,000

All tiers include unlimited mailboxes/warmup and CRM integration. **API access (what this integration needs) requires Pro or higher** — Base does not include API access.

Overage behavior: Smartlead doesn't bill overage. Once you hit the monthly send cap, sending pauses until you upgrade or the billing cycle resets — no surprise charges, but a live campaign can stall mid-sequence if nobody's watching usage.

Cost of what this integration actually does, per campaign

Worked example using this app's own numbers (8 lookalike companies, ~5 contacts each, a 4-step sequence — roughly what a single "New campaign" wizard run produces):

• **1 credit = 1 verified contact revealed.** Your Smartlead plan tier sets the monthly credit allowance (matches the plan's contact cap — e.g. Pro's 30,000).

• **Dashboard-only.** As of September 2026 there is no documented `/prospects` or `/smartprospect` REST endpoint — it can't be called from this app's API routes the way `/api/lookalikes` and `/api/contacts` call Ocean.io. If SmartProspect ships an API later, it'd be the natural replacement for Ocean.io; until then those two routes stay as they are.

Sources

• Azure OpenAI Service pricing

- Smartlead pricing

• Smartlead pricing plans — help center

• Full API documentation — help center

[Getting started with SmartProspect — help center](#)

• SmartProspect — free B2B leads